# 2018 Hyundai Elantra

$4,900 · 137,000 miles · Private seller · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/bakersfield-2018-hyundai-elantra-137k/6DexQBftyFLLtDXa22fVwC

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 4 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$5,540** | **$439** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 0 recalls · 284 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $4,900.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $453.25 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $31.85 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $32.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $5,540.10 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $540.10 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $10.82 |
| Total interest over the loan | $109.25 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $10.82 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 32 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $148.44 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $130.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.15 |
| Total per month | $439.41 |

Running costs without the loan: **$429/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$10,871** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

Average. The 2017-2020 Elantra's 2.0L 'Nu' engine and 6-speed automatic are generally solid and get about 37 MPG on the highway, but Hyundai's warranty transfers don't apply to used buyers, and this one shows cosmetic wear.

NHTSA data for this model year: 0 recalls · 284 owner complaints (12 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (142), Unknown Or Other (54), Electrical System (43), Power Train (24), Fuel/Propulsion System (19), Steering (16).

**Known issues for this model**

• Some 2.0L Nu engines develop piston-slap/ticking or oil consumption at high miles

• Cosmetic damage (dents, cracked bumper) - insurance/resale

• Infotainment glitches

**Check on this car before buying**

• Listen for ticking/knocking at cold start

• Check for a lit check-engine light and get a scan

• Ask for a smog certificate (seller must provide)

• Run VIN for recalls

## Notes

$4,900, 137k mi, 2.0L 4-cyl, automatic. Clean title (seller stresses not salvage). Runs/drives great, 'fully loaded'; has dents, paint not great, cracked bumper.

Newest car in this price range. Seller moving abroad -> may sell fast / negotiate.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.